Piano LESSON WITH WARREN

Seven Steps To Naming Any Chord.



1. Arrange notes in alphabetically order.

1b. Arrange notes in stacked thirds (every other note).

2. Find the three notes that forms the core triad

3. Determine the quality of the triad (Major, Minor Diminished, Augmented, Sus4)

4. Is there a 4th note that functions as the 6th or 7th (major seventh or minor seventh)?

5. Is there a 5th note that functions as the 9th (b9 or #9)

6. Is there a 6th note that functions as the 11th (or #11)?

7. Is there a 7th note that functions as the 13th (or b13)?

Chord Examples

1. C maj7
2. Dm7
3. E(add9)
4. C7(#5#9)
5. C13(#11)
6. F#m6/9
7. Cm6/9
8. F7(#5 b9)
9. D7
10. B13
11. G#m13
12. Dm11
13. Gm9
14. C#m6
15. Em7(b5)
16. Dm9(b5)

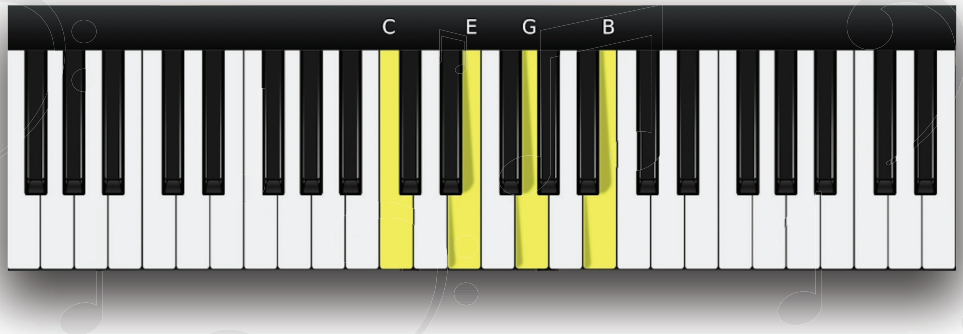
#1. What is the chord shown below?



The steps we need are:

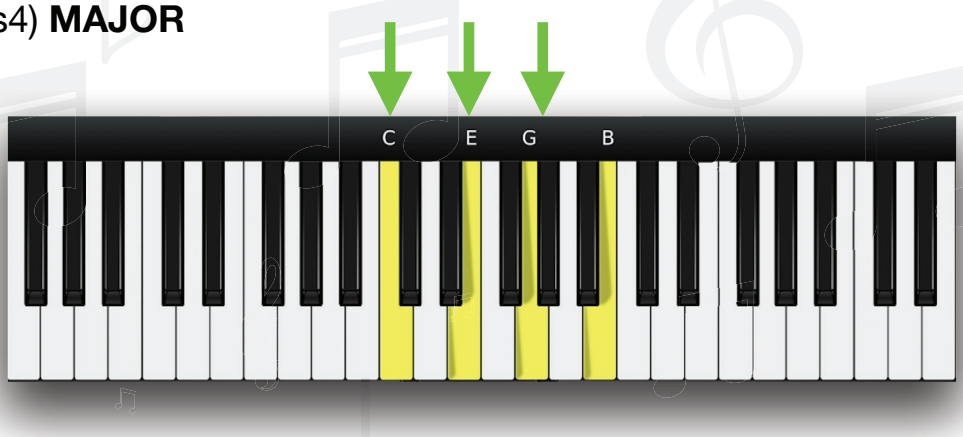
1. Arrange notes in alphabetically order.

1b. Arrange notes in stacked thirds (every other note).

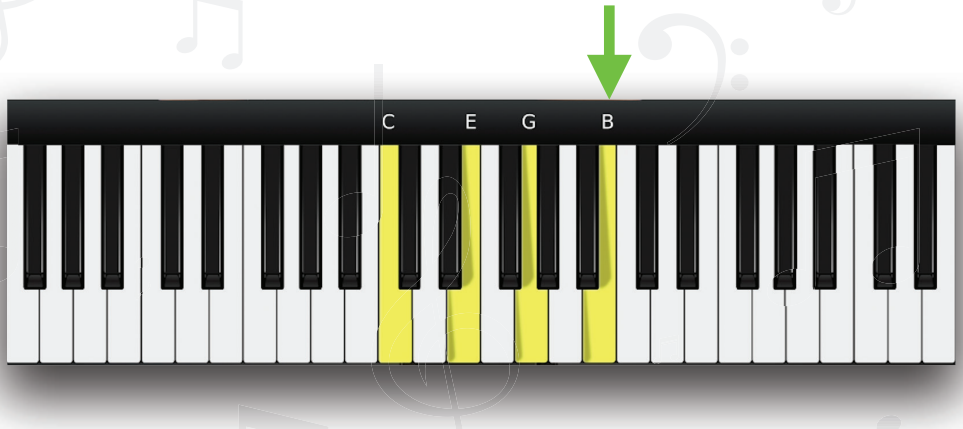


Find the three notes that forms the core triad

2. Determine the quality of the triad (Major, Minor Diminished, Augmented,
3. Sus4) **MAJOR**

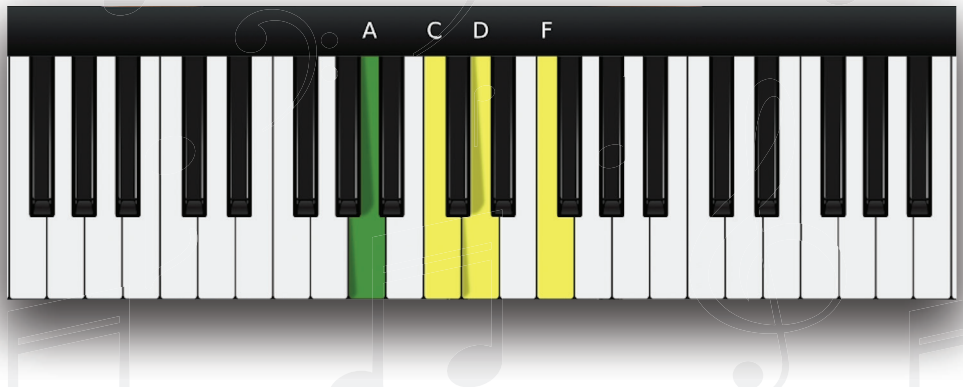


4. Is there a 4th note that functions as the 7th (major or minor)?



The Chord is: **Cmaj7**

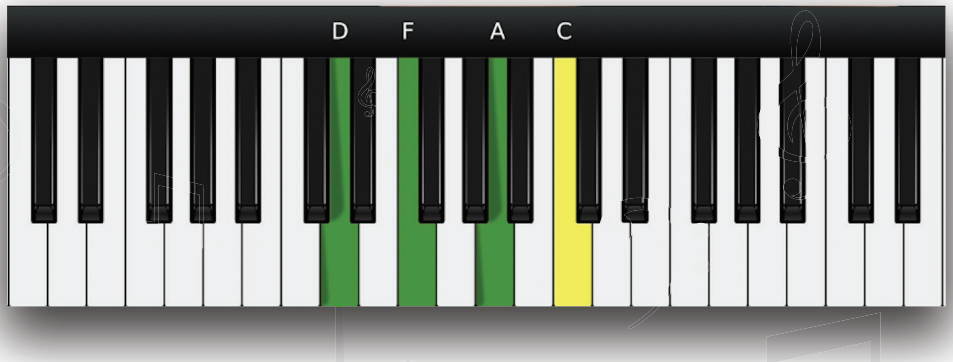
#2. What is the chord shown below?



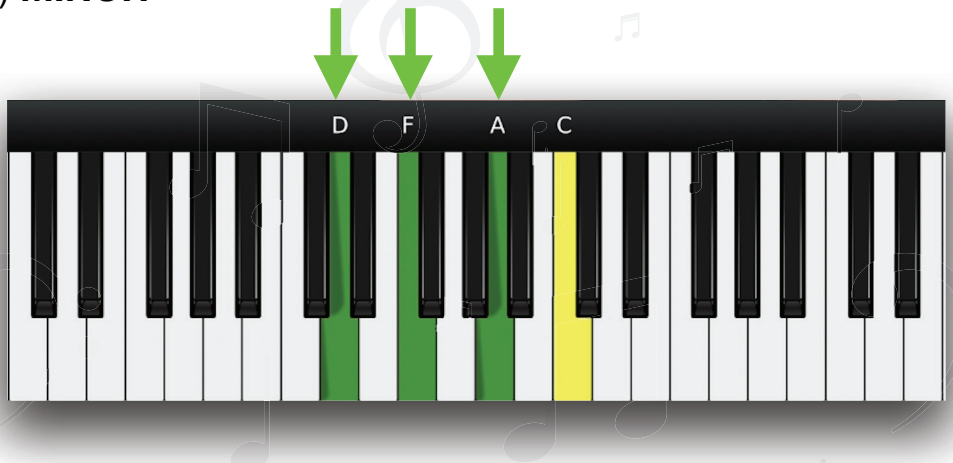
The first two things we do are:

1. Arrange notes in alphabetically order.

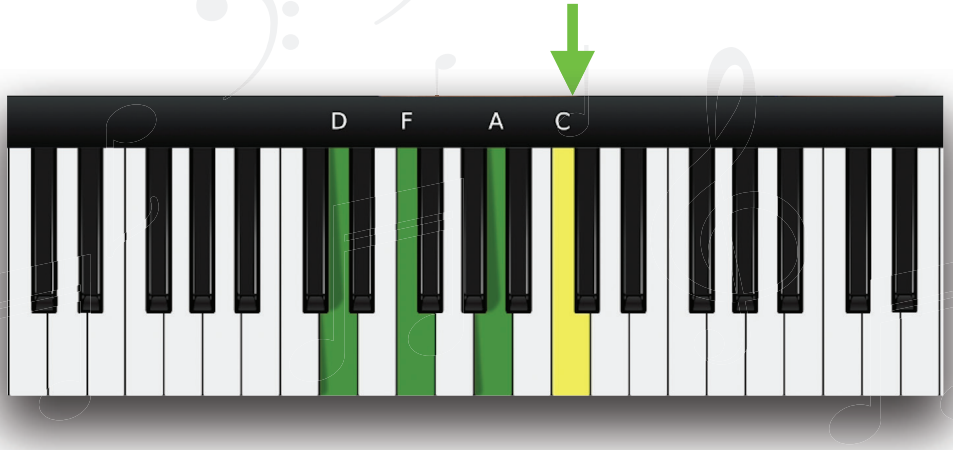
1b. Arrange notes in stacked thirds (every other note).



2. Determine the quality of the triad (Major, Minor Diminished, Augmented, Sus4) **MINOR**



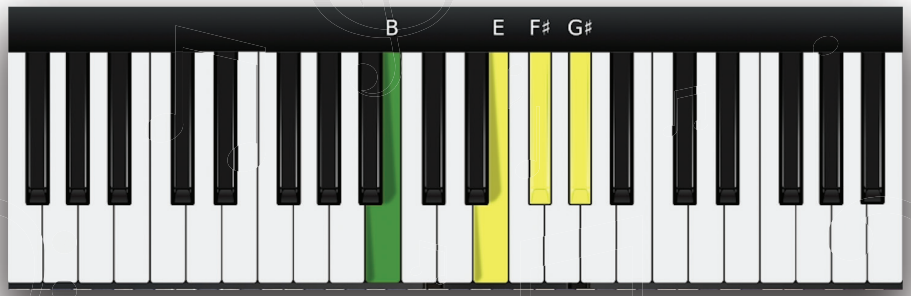
3. Is there a 4th note that functions as the 7th (major or minor)?



The Chord is: **Dm7**

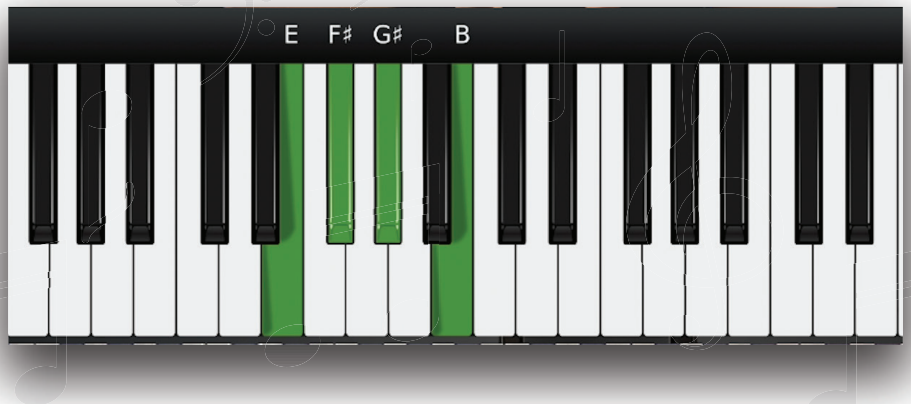
IMPORTANT: the notes of an minor7 chord can also be rearranged to become a major6 chord. For example, if we rearranged “D F A C” to “F A C D” this becomes the **F6 chord.**

#3. What is the chord shown below?

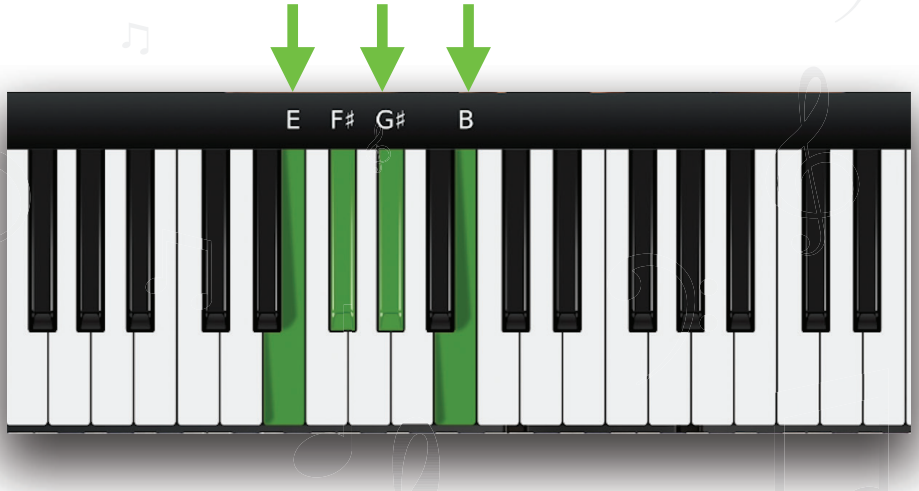


1. Arrange notes in alphabetically order.

1b. Arrange notes in stacked thirds (every other note).

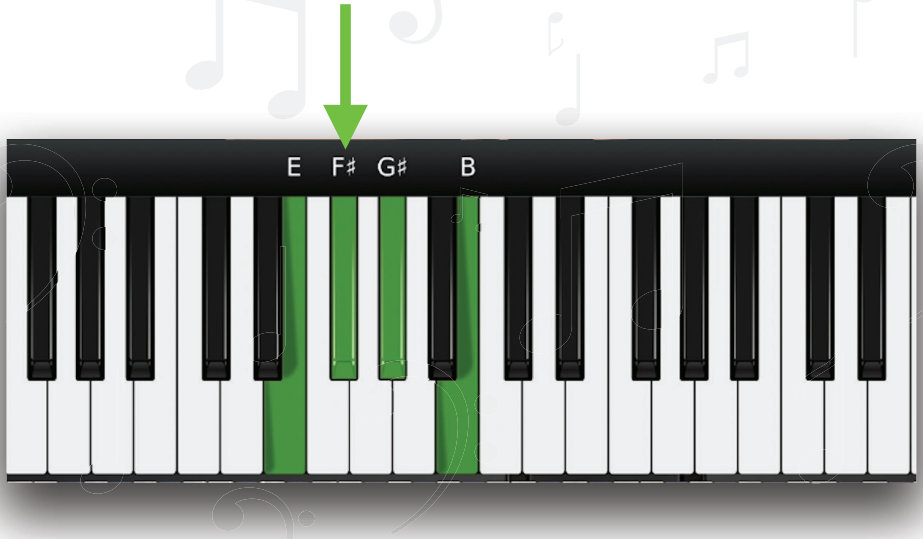


2. Find the three notes that forms the core triad
3. Determine the quality of the triad (Major, Minor Diminished, Augmented, Sus4) **MAJOR**



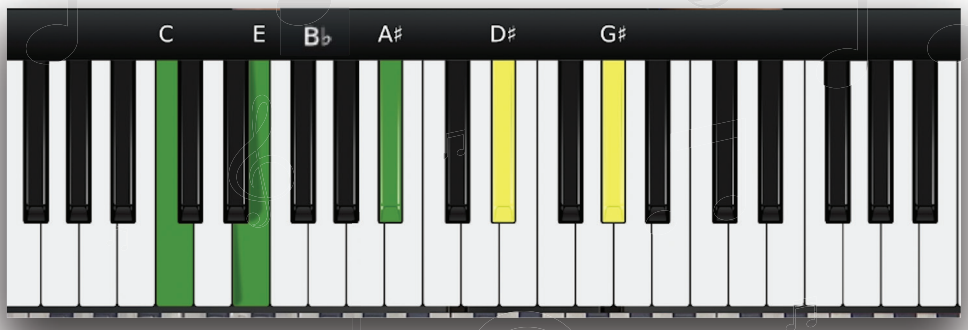
4. Is there a 4th note that functions as the 7th (major or minor)? **NO**

5. Is there a 5th note that functions as the 9th (b9 or #9) **YES**



The Chord is: **E(add9)**

#4. What is the chord shown below?

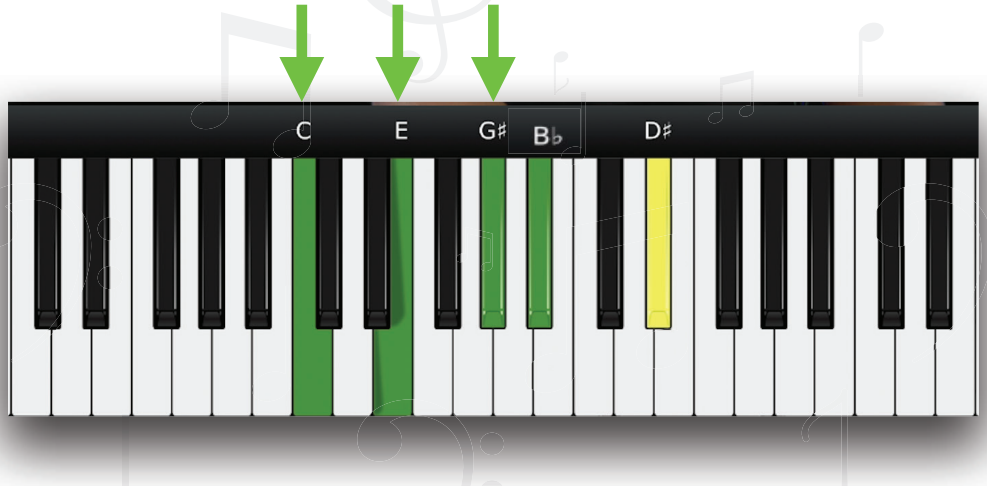


1. Arrange notes in alphabetically order.

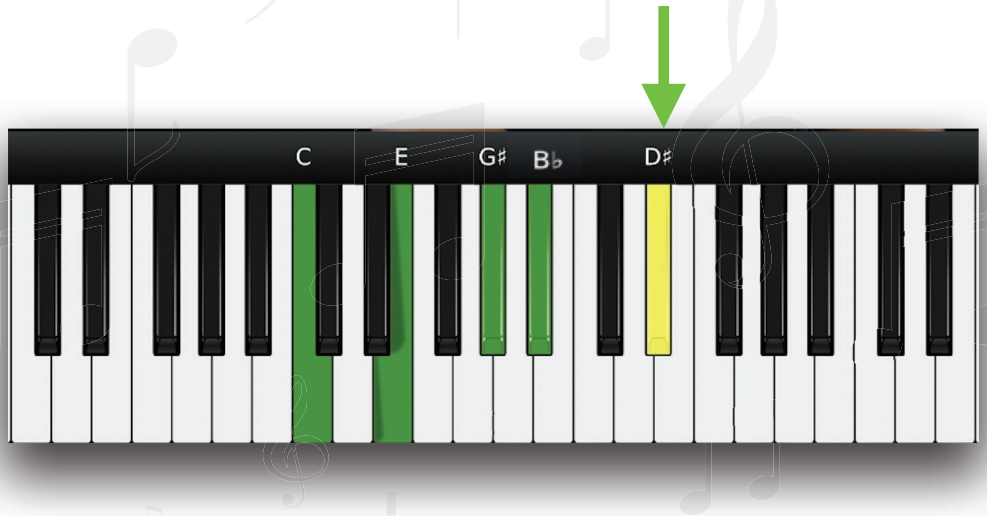
1b. Arrange notes in stacked thirds (every other note).

2. Find the three notes that forms the core triad

3. Determine the quality of the triad (Major, Minor Diminished, Augmented, Sus4) **AUGMENTED**



4. Is there a 5th note that functions as the 9th (b9 or #9) **YES**



The Chord is: **C7(#5#9)**

#5.What is the chord shown below?

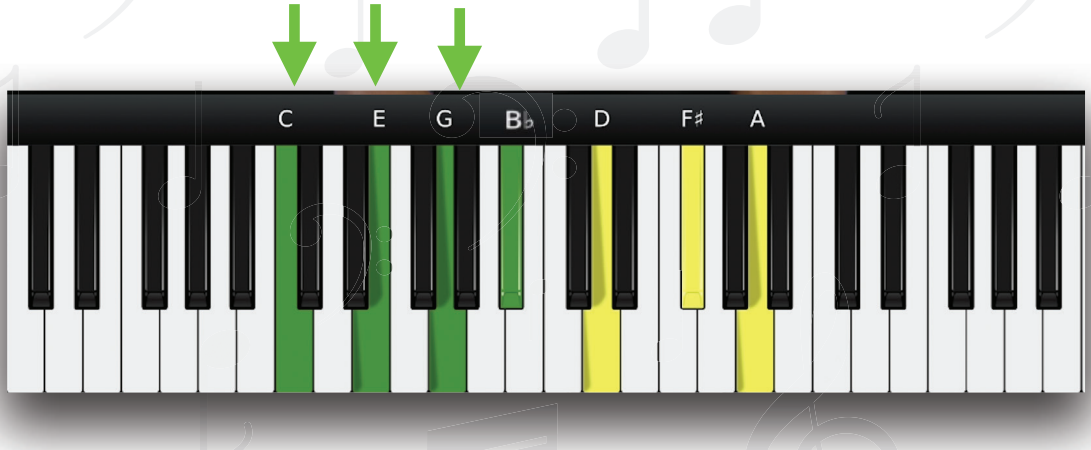


1. Arrange notes in alphabetically order.

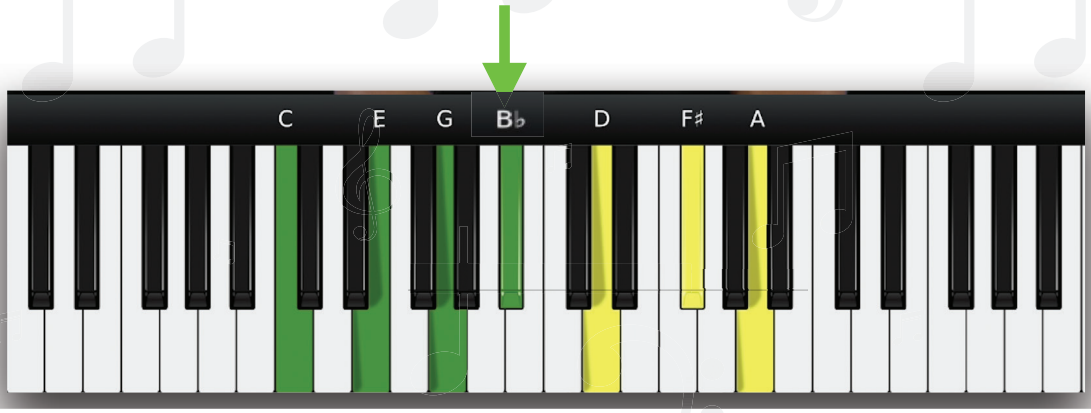
1b. Arrange notes in stacked thirds (every other note).

2. Find the three notes that forms the core triad.

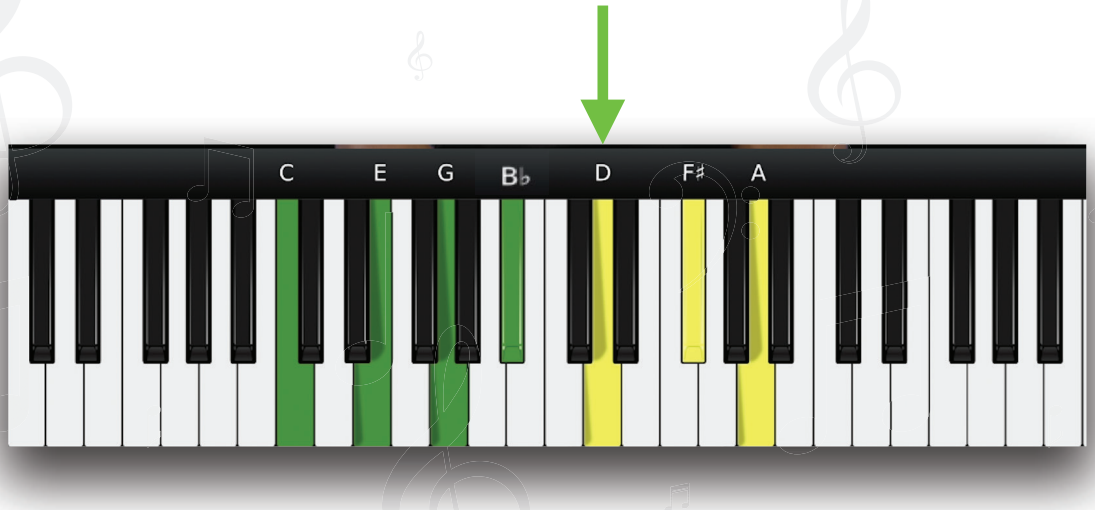
3. Determine the quality of the triad (Major, Minor Diminished, Augmented, Sus4). **MAJOR**



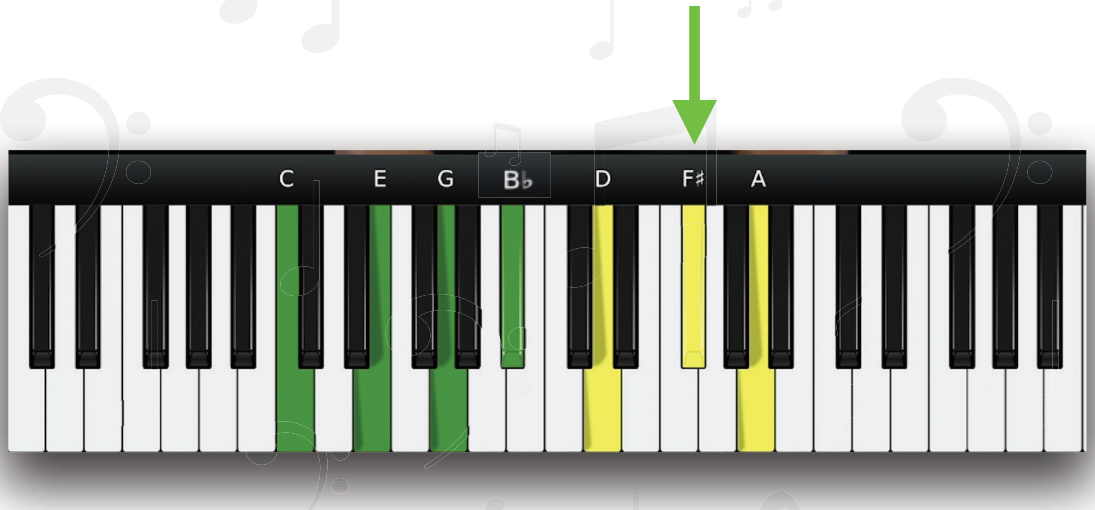
4. Is there a 4th note that functions as the 7th (major or minor)? **YES**



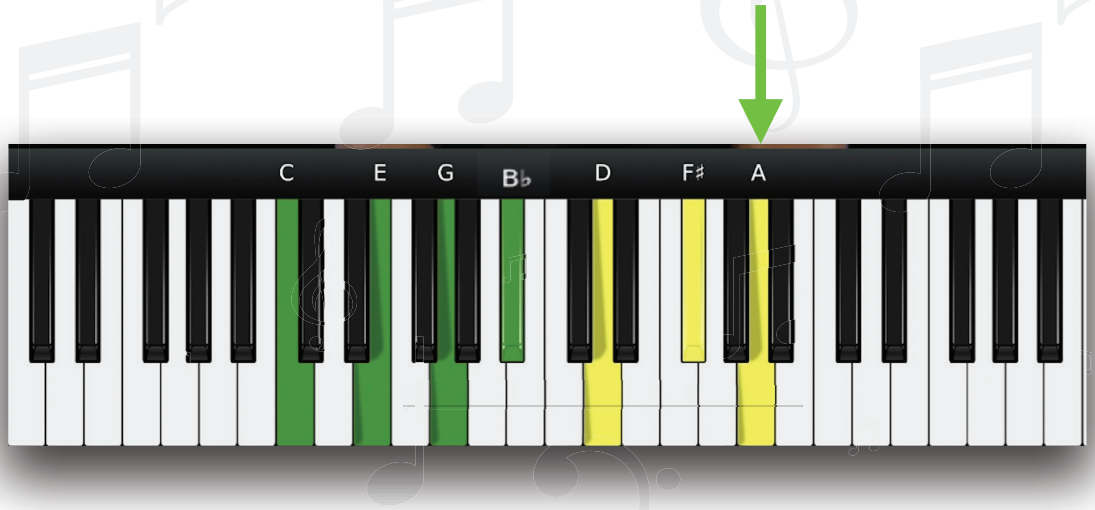
5. Is there a 5th note that functions as the 9th (b9 or #9) **YES**



6. Is there a 6th note that functions as the 11th (or #11)? **YES**



7. Is there a 7th note that functions as the 13th (or b13)? **YES**



#6. What is the chord shown below?

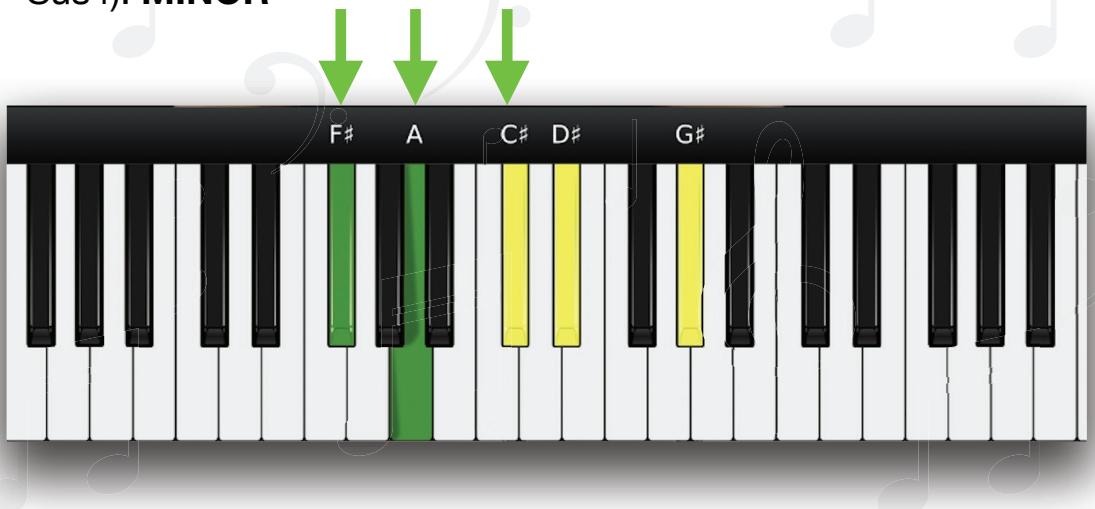


1. Arrange notes in alphabetically order.

1b. Arrange notes in stacked thirds (every other note).

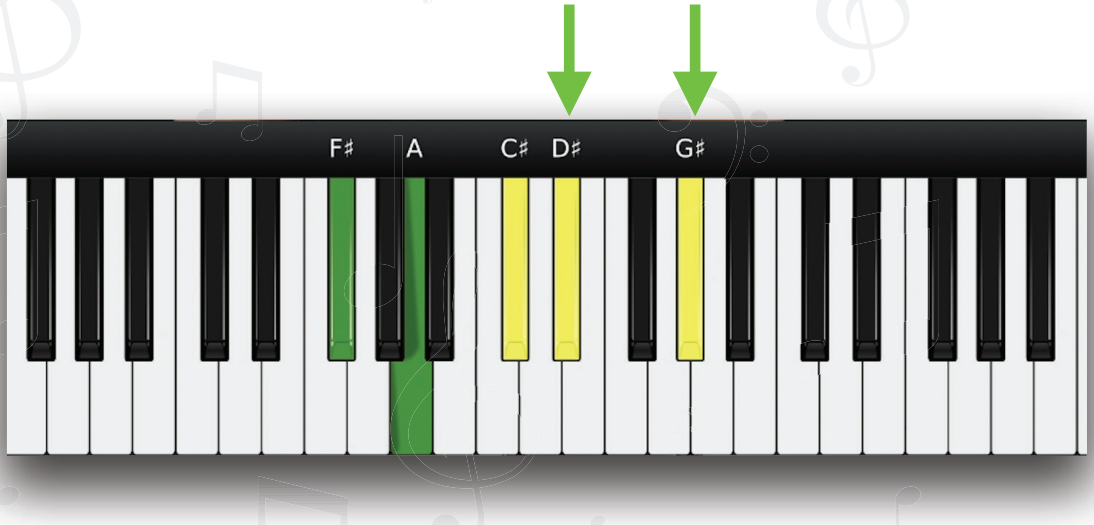
2. Find the three notes that forms the core triad.

3. Determine the quality of the triad (Major, Minor Diminished, Augmented, Sus4). **MINOR**



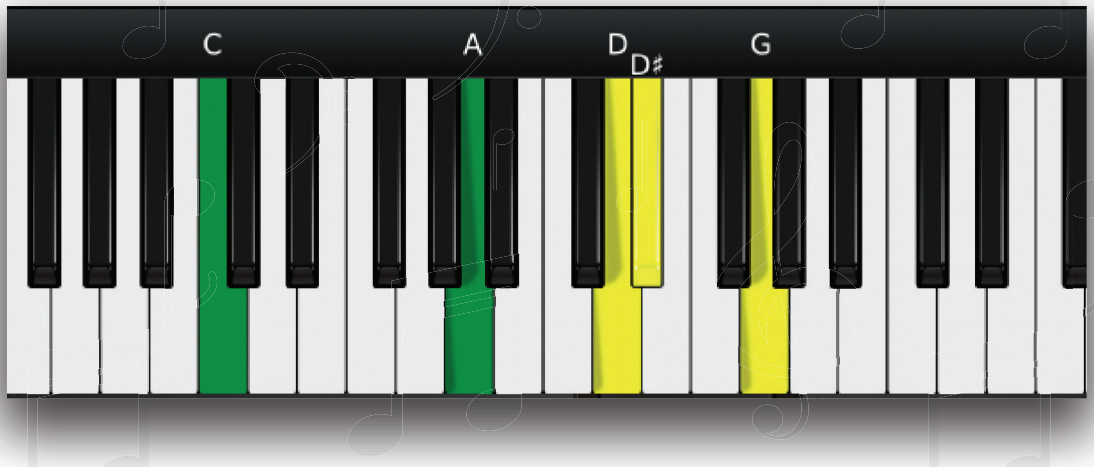
4. Is there a 4th note that functions as the 7th (major or minor)? **NO**

5. Is there a 5th note that functions as the 6th or 9th (b9 or #9) **YES**



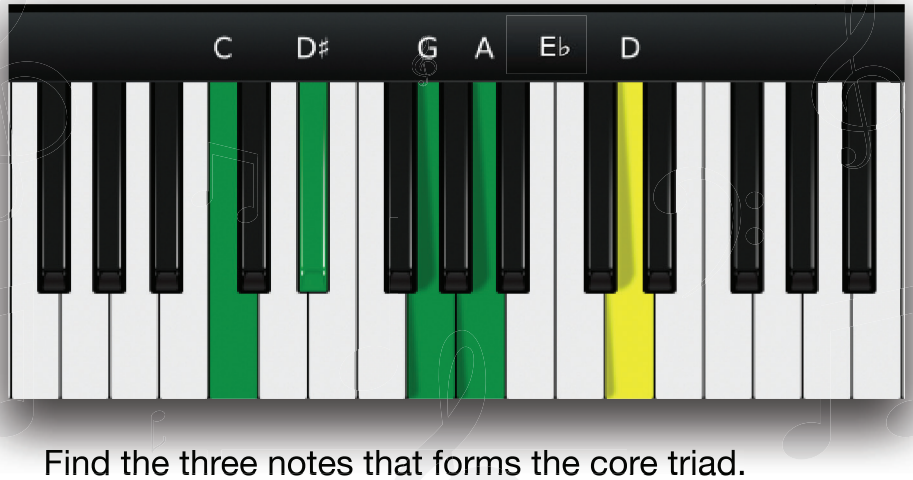
The Chord is: **F#m6/9**

#7. What is the chord shown below?



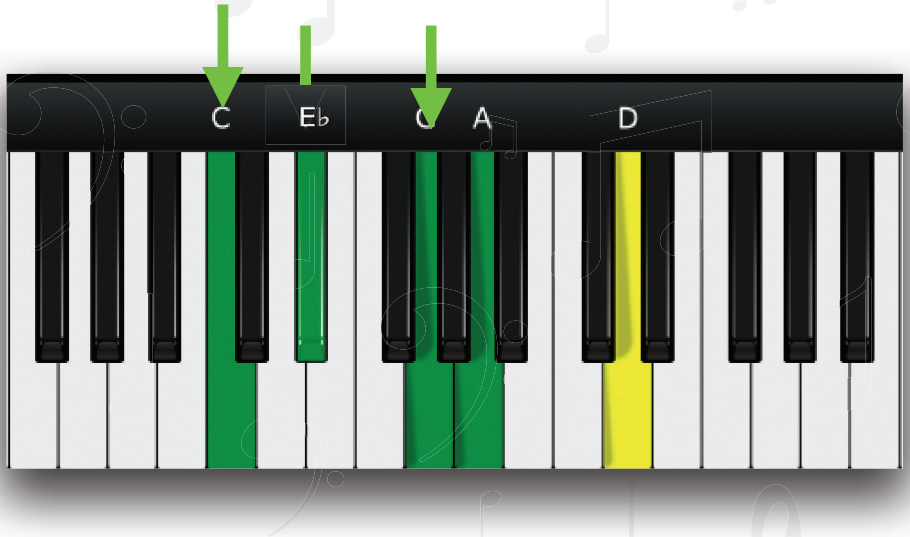
1. Arrange notes in alphabetically order.

1b. Arrange notes in stacked thirds (every other note).



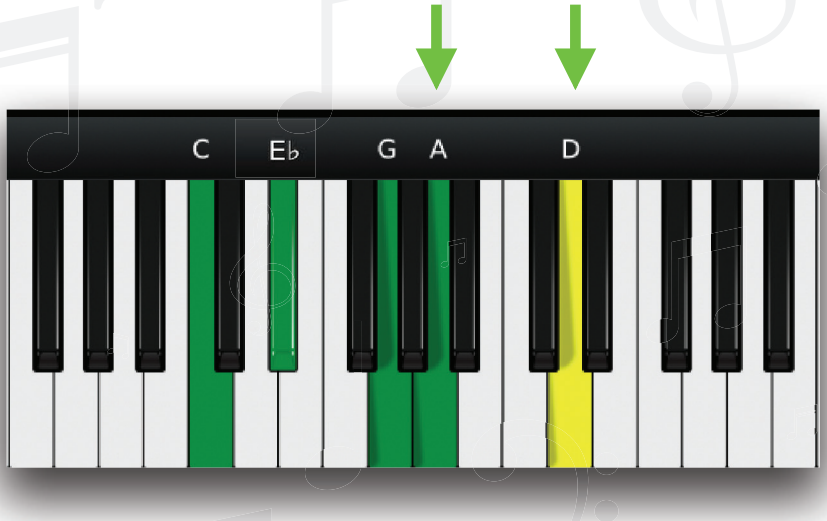
2. Find the three notes that forms the core triad.

3. Determine the quality of the triad (Major, Minor Diminished, Augmented, Sus4).**MINOR**



4. Is there a 4th note that functions as the 7th (major or minor)? **NO**

5. Is there a 5th note that functions as the 6th or 9th (b9 or #9) **YES**

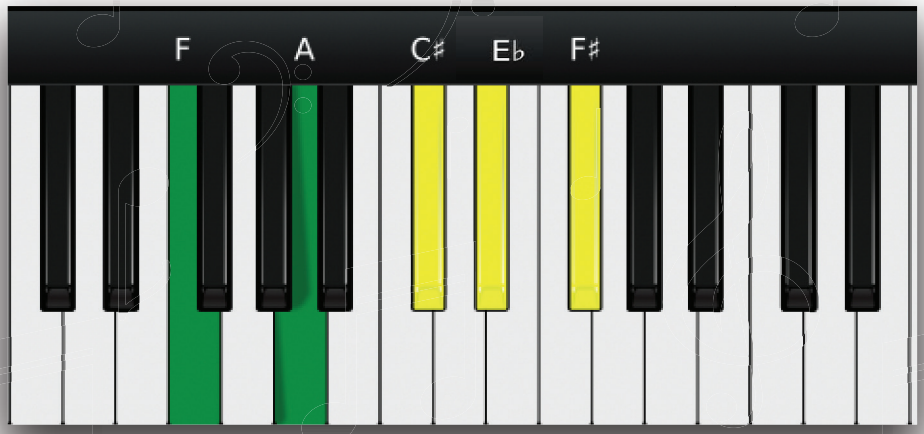


#8. What is the chord shown below?

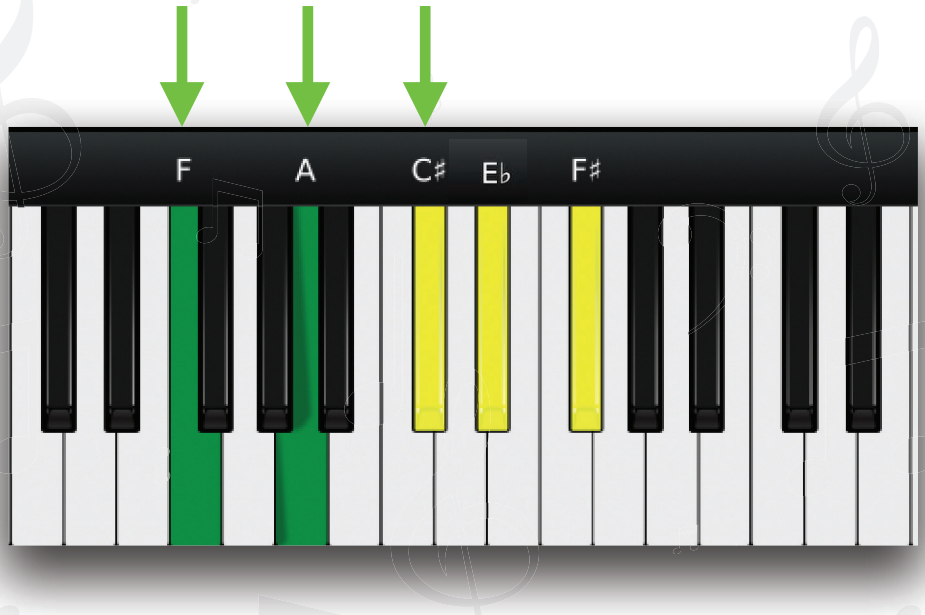


1. Arrange notes in alphabetically order.

1b. Arrange notes in stacked thirds (every other note).

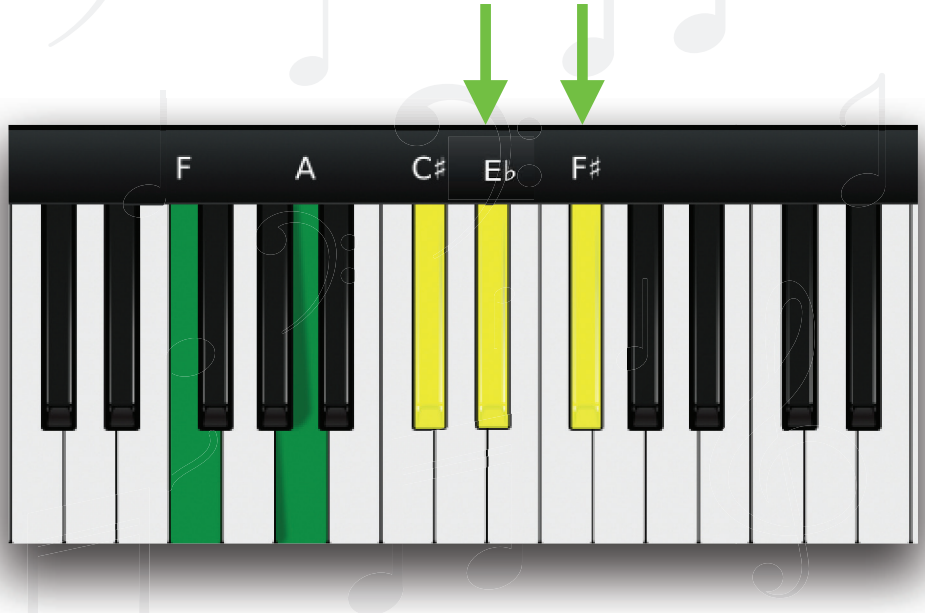


2. Find the three notes that forms the core triad.
3. Determine the quality of the triad (Major, Minor Diminished, Augmented, Sus4). **Augmented**



4. Is there a 4th note that functions as the 7th (major or minor)? **YES**

5. Is there a 5th note that functions as the 6th or 9th (b9 or #9) **YES**



The Chord is: **F7(#5 b9)**

#9. What is the chord shown below?

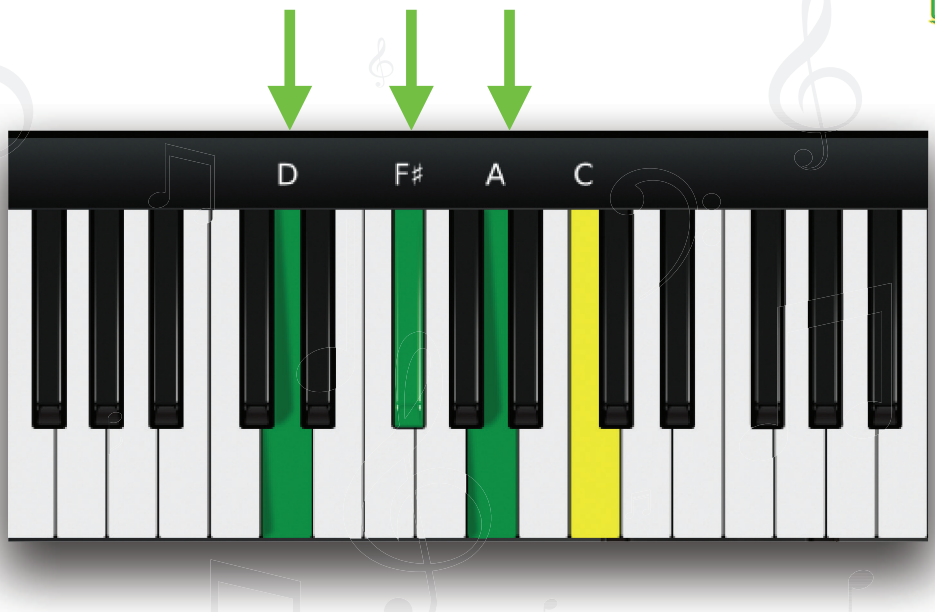


1. Arrange notes in alphabetically order.

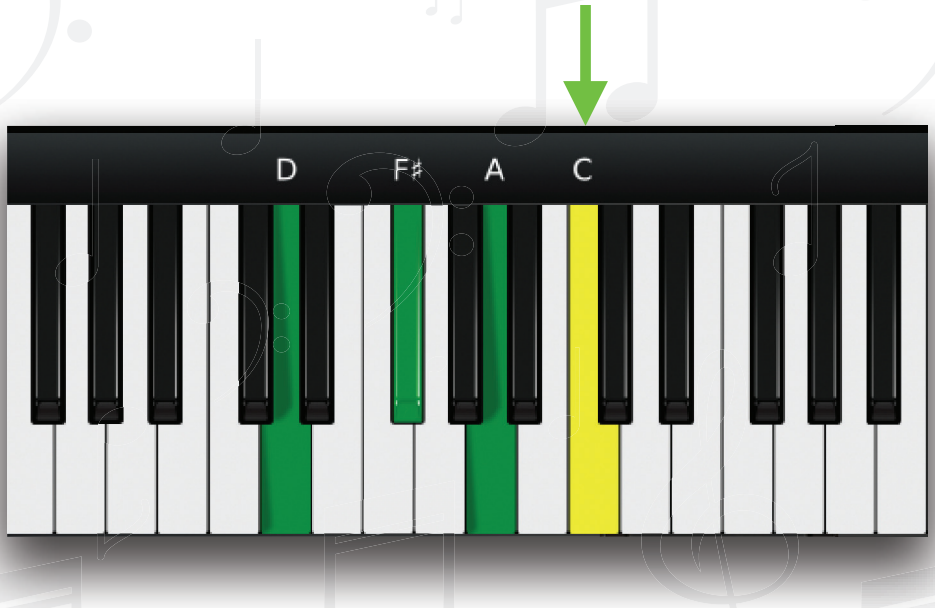
1b. Arrange notes in stacked thirds (every other note).



2. Find the three notes that forms the core triad.
3. Determine the quality of the triad (Major, Minor Diminished, Augmented, Sus4). **Major**

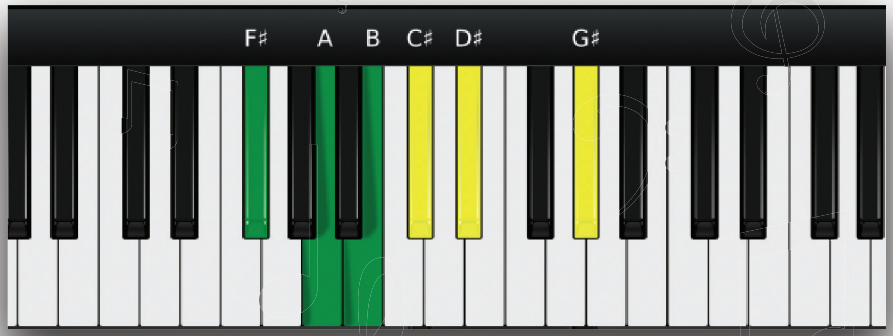


4. Is there a 4th note that functions as the 7th (major or minor)? **YES**



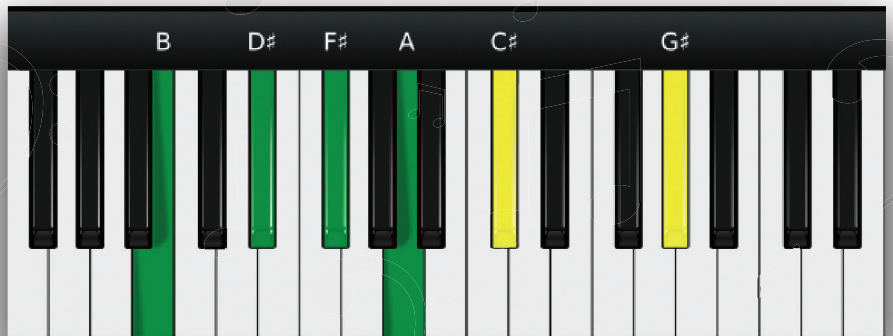
The Chord is: **D7**

#10. What is the chord shown below?



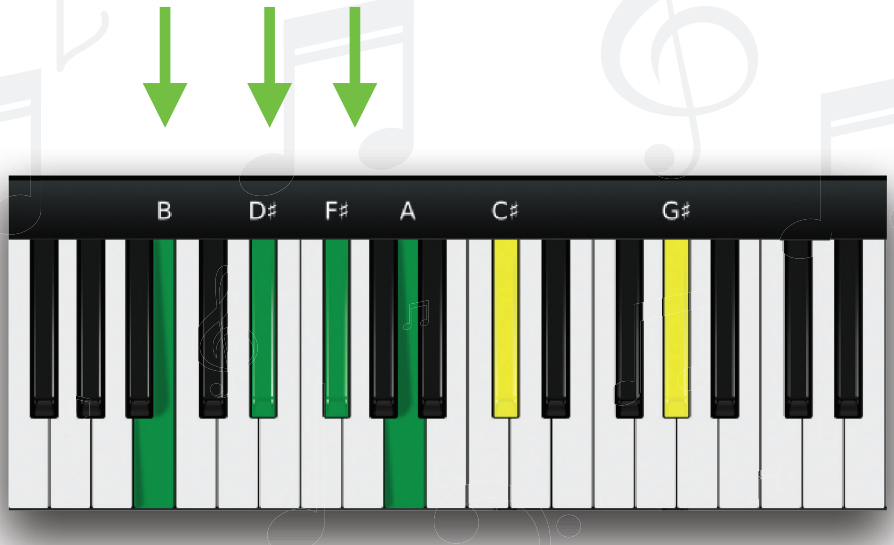
1. Arrange notes in alphabetically order.

1b. Arrange notes in stacked thirds (every other note).

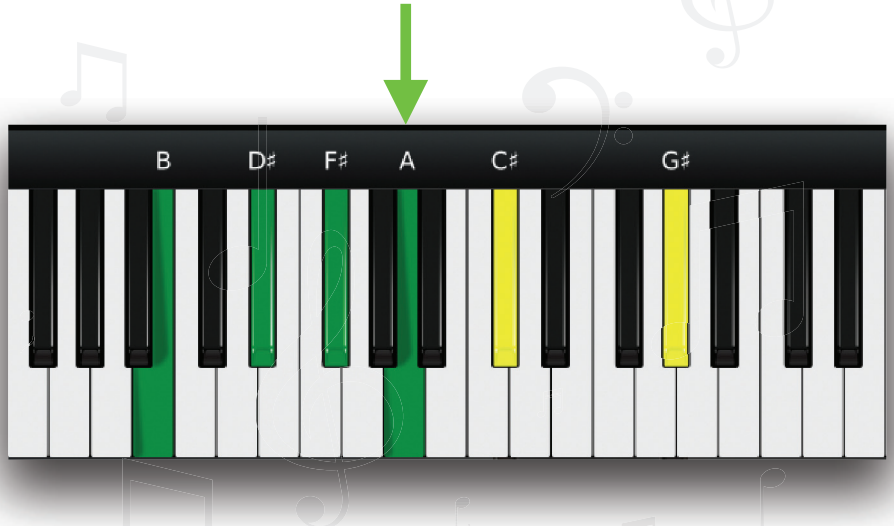


2. Find the three notes that forms the core triad.

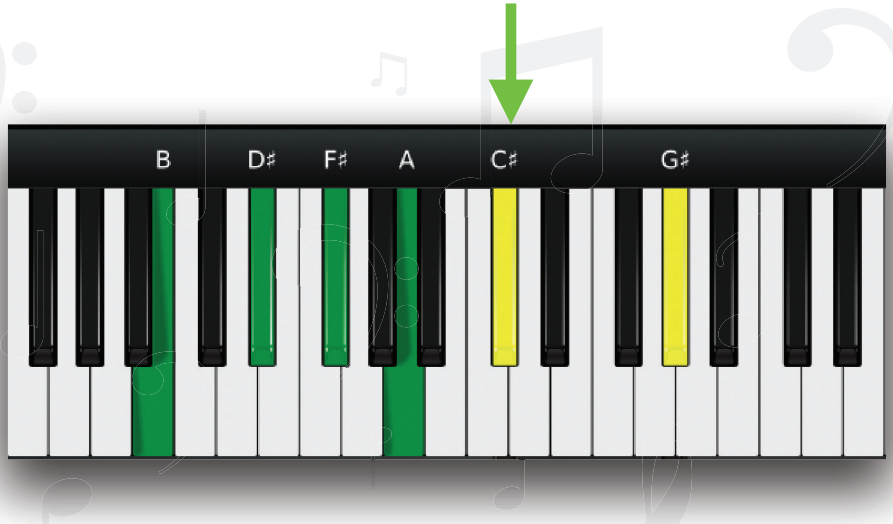
3. Determine the quality of the triad (Major, Minor Diminished, Augmented, Sus4). **Major**



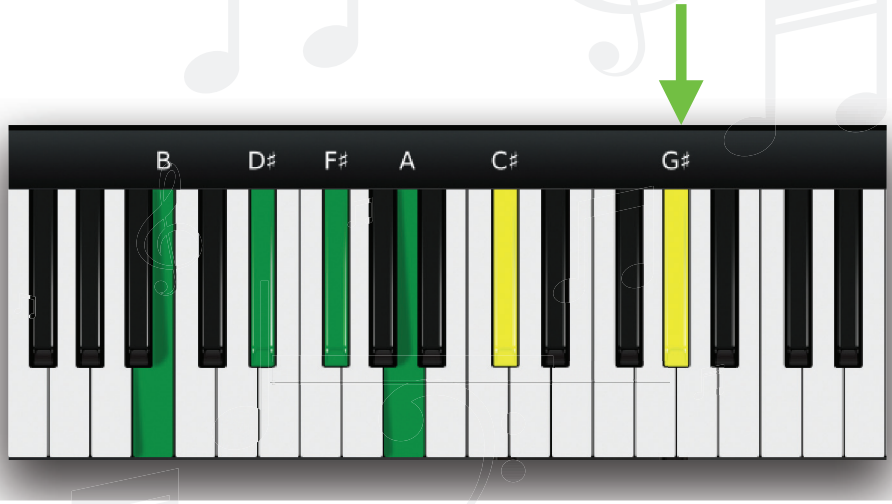
4. Is there a 4th note that functions as the 7th (major or minor)? **YES**



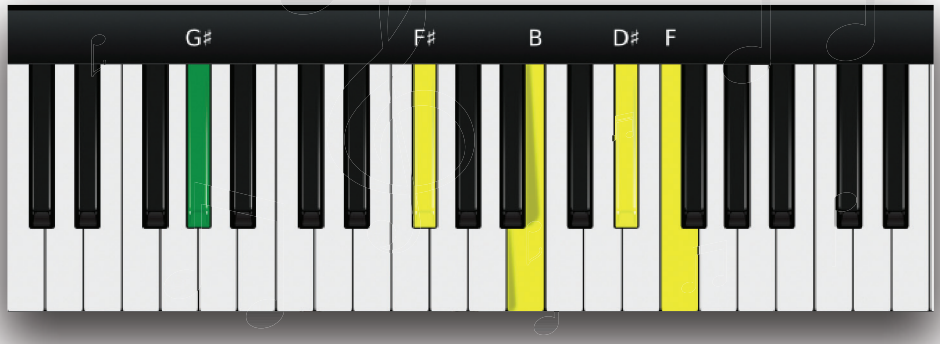
5. Is there a 5th note that functions as the 6th or 9th (b9 or #9) **YES**



6. Is there a 7th note that functions as the 13th (or b13)? **YES**

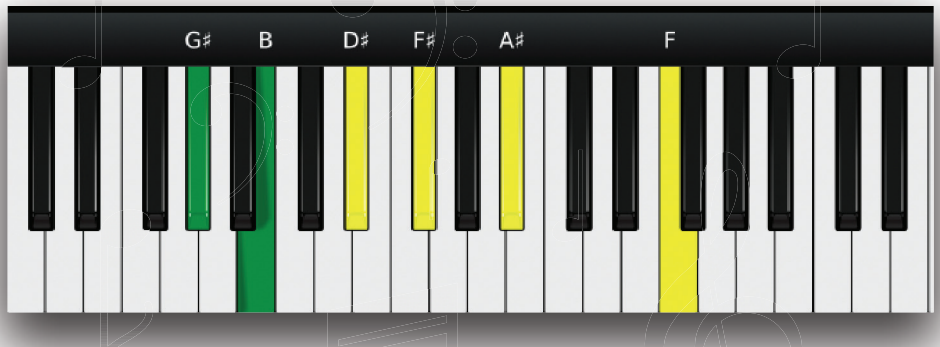


#11. What is the chord shown below?

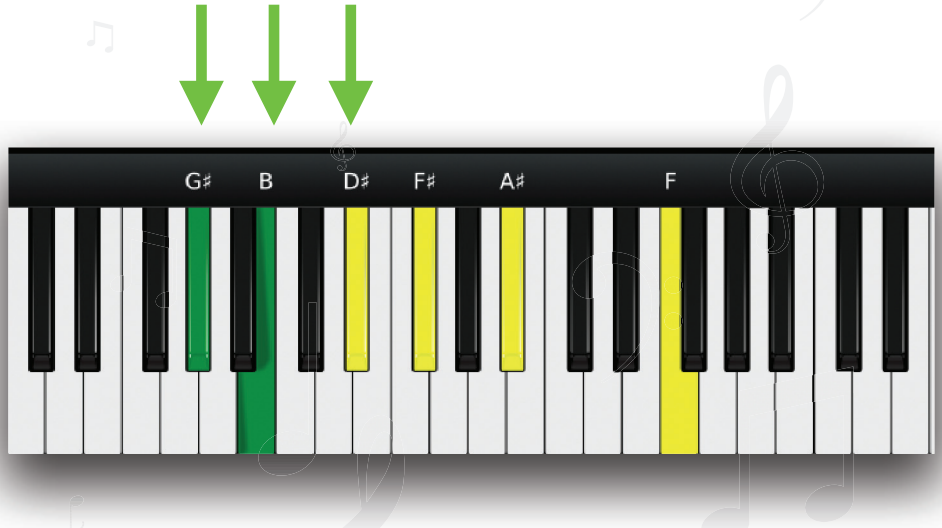


1. Arrange notes in alphabetically order.

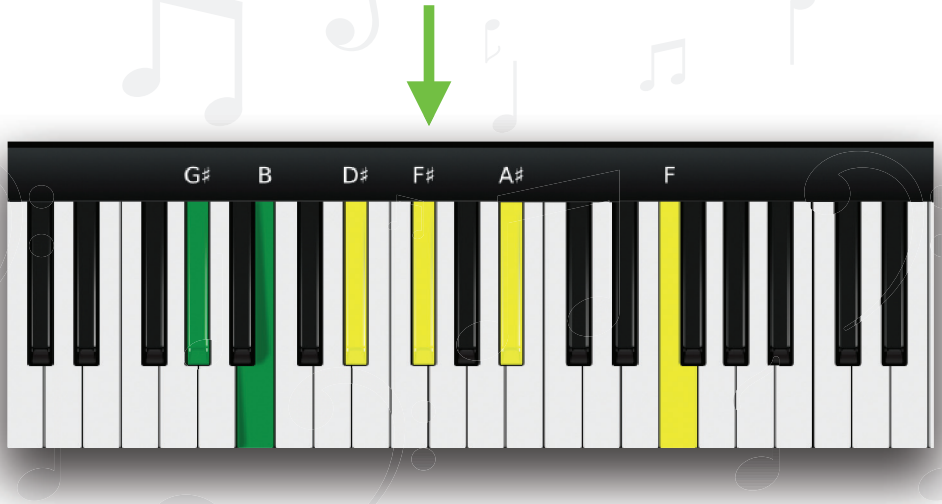
1b. Arrange notes in stacked thirds (every other note).



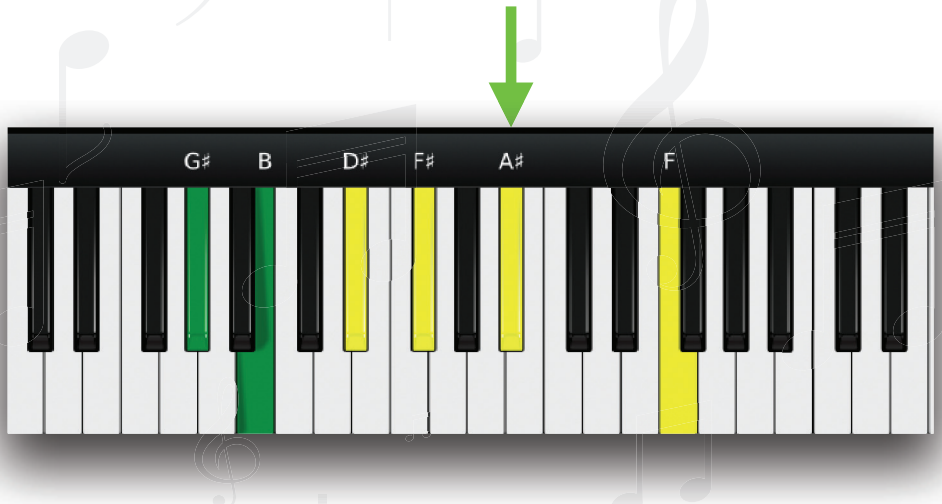
2. Find the three notes that forms the core triad.
3. Determine the quality of the triad (Major, Minor Diminished, Augmented, Sus4). **Minor**



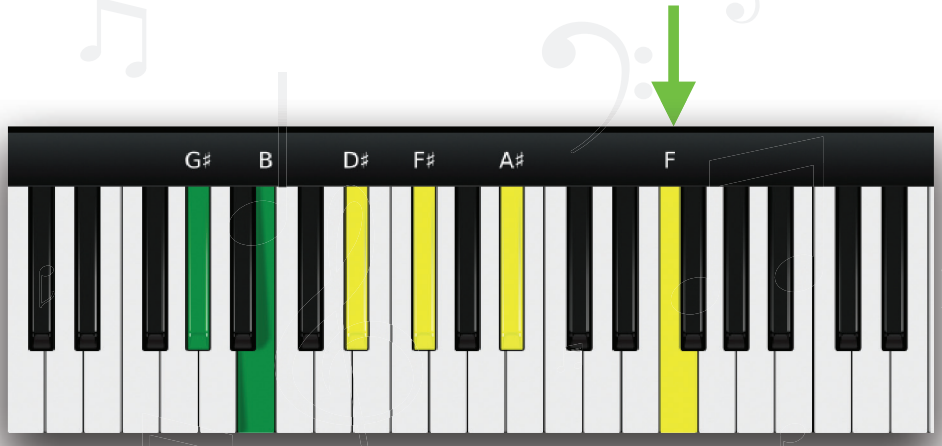
4. Is there a 4th note that functions as the 7th (major or minor)? **YES**



5. Is there a 5th note that functions as the 6th or 9th (b9 or #9) **YES**

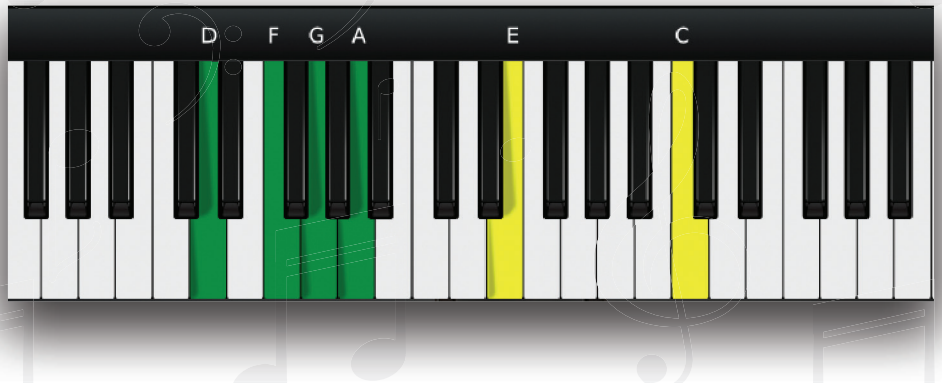


6. Is there a 7th note that functions as the 13th (or b13)? **YES**



The Chord is: **G#m13**

#12. What is the chord shown below?



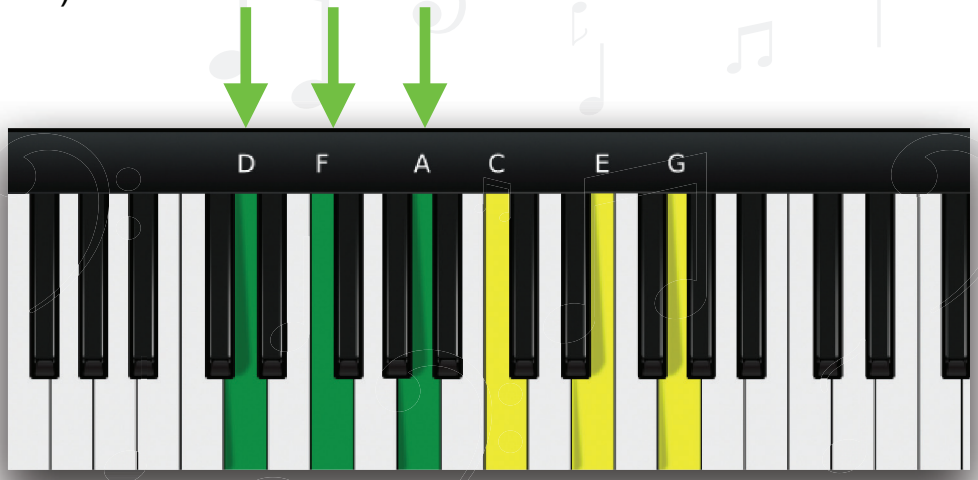
1. Arrange notes in alphabetically order.

1b. Arrange notes in stacked thirds (every other note).

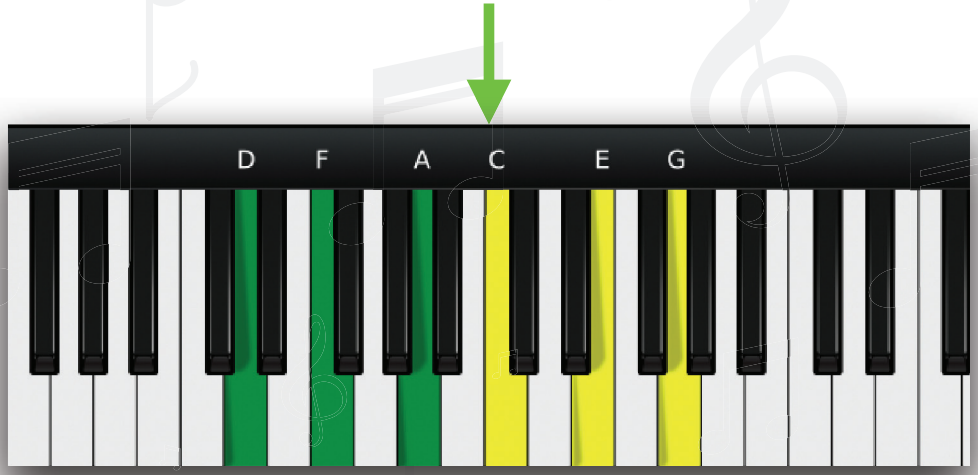


2. Find the three notes that forms the core triad.

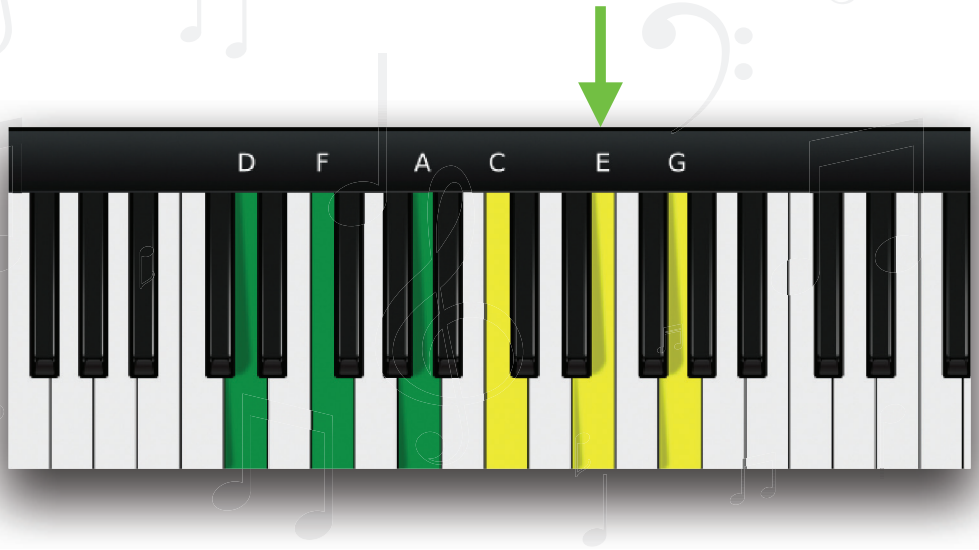
3. Determine the quality of the triad (Major, Minor Diminished, Augmented, Sus4). **Minor**



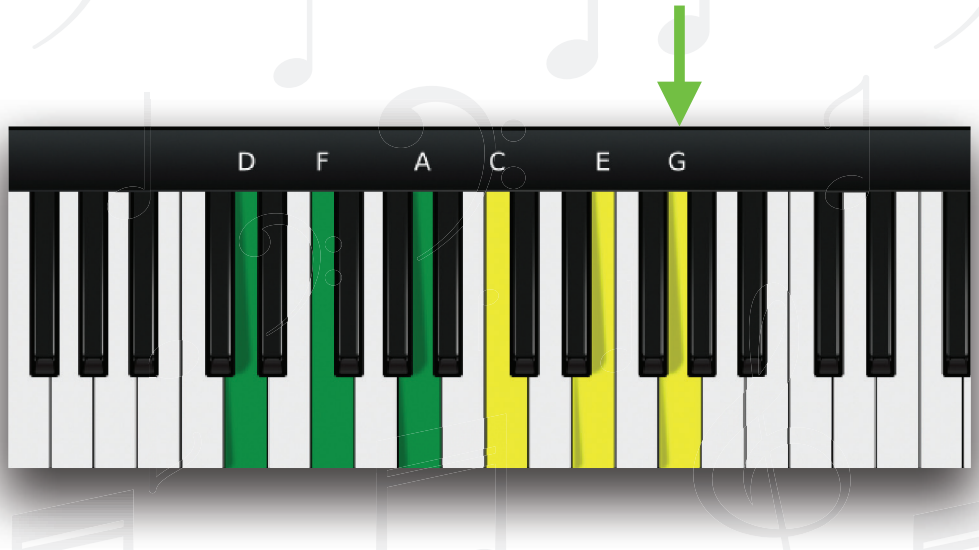
4. Is there a 4th note that functions as the 7th (major or minor)? **YES**



5. Is there a 5th note that functions as the 6th or 9th (b9 or #9) **YES**

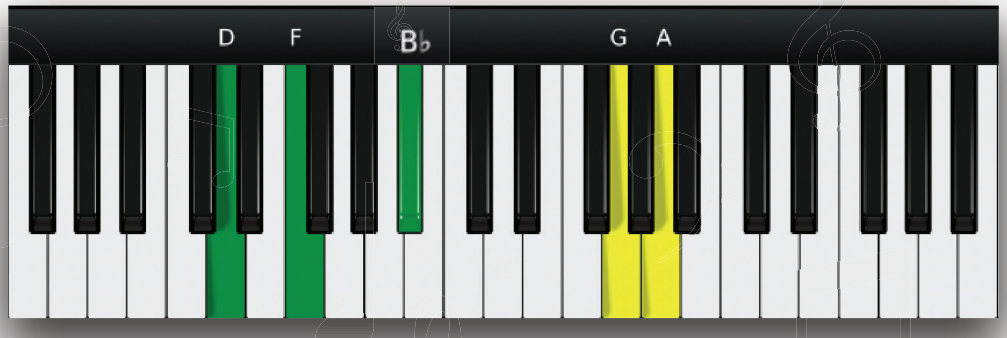


6. Is there a 6th note that functions as the 11th or #11? **YES**



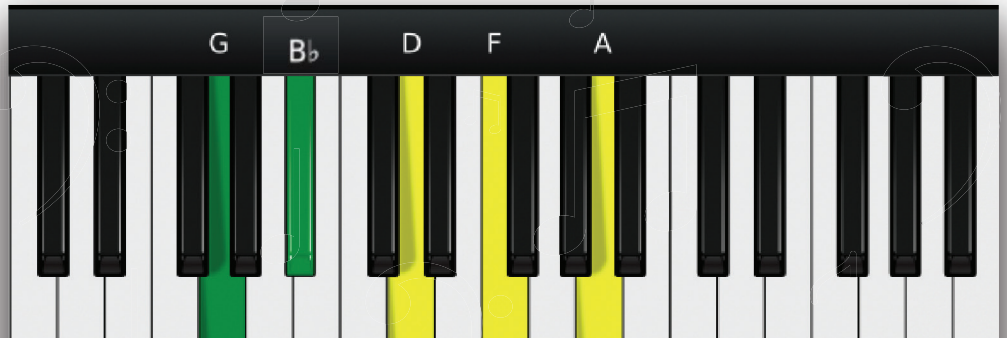
The Chord is: **Dm11**

#13. What is the chord shown below?



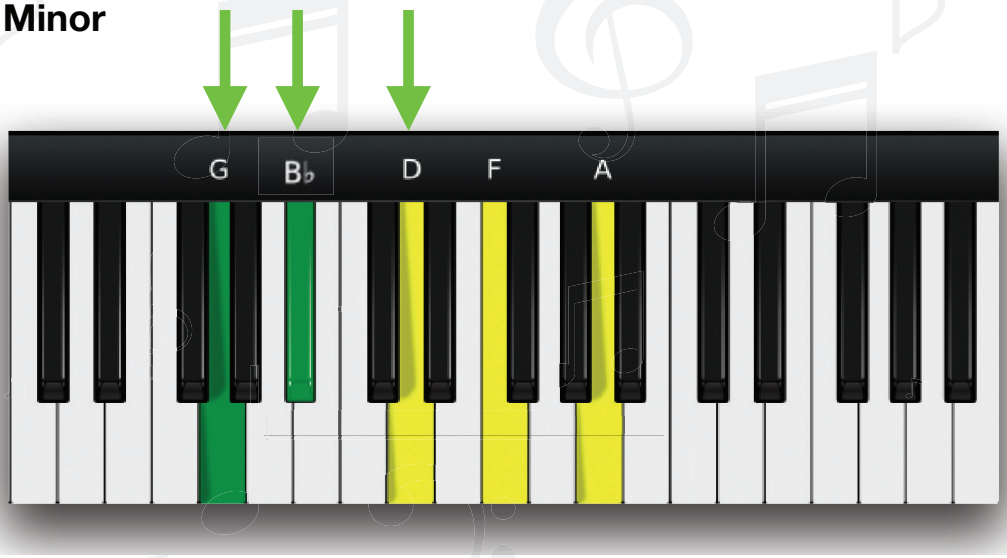
1. Arrange notes in alphabetically order.

1b. Arrange notes in stacked thirds (every other note).

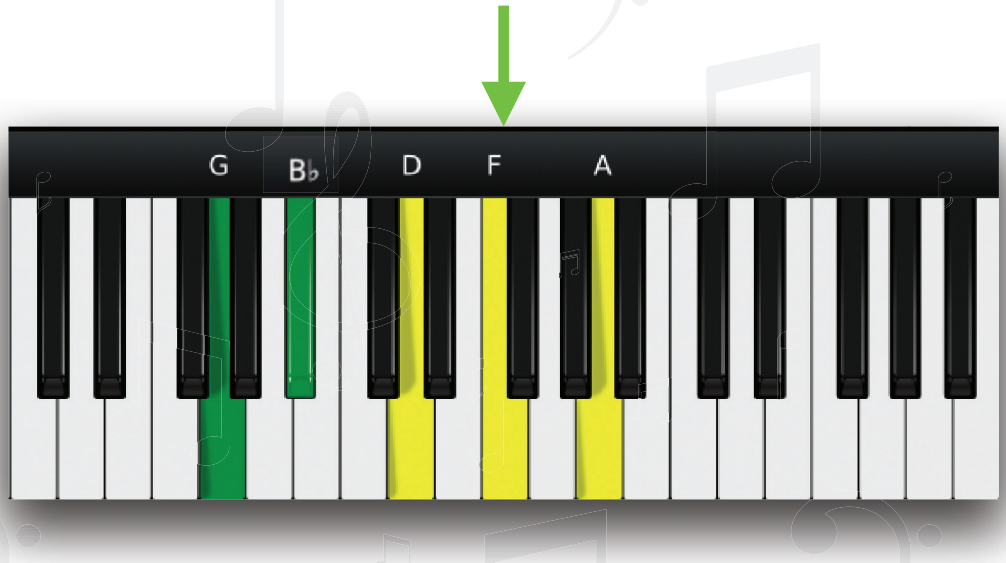


2. Find the three notes that forms the core triad.

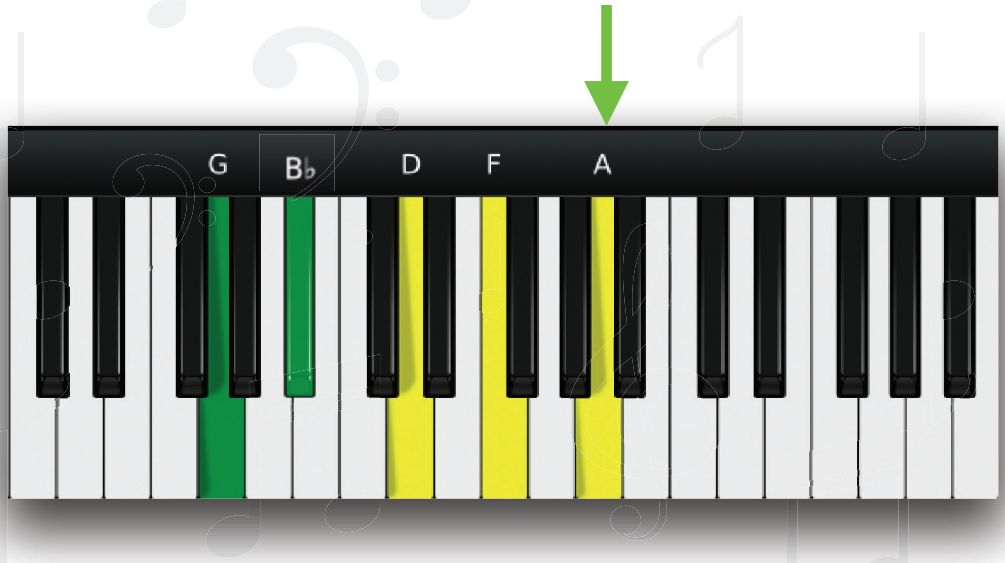
3. Determine the quality of the triad (Major, Minor Diminished, Augmented, Sus4). **Minor**



4. Is there a 4th note that functions as the 7th (major or minor)? **YES**

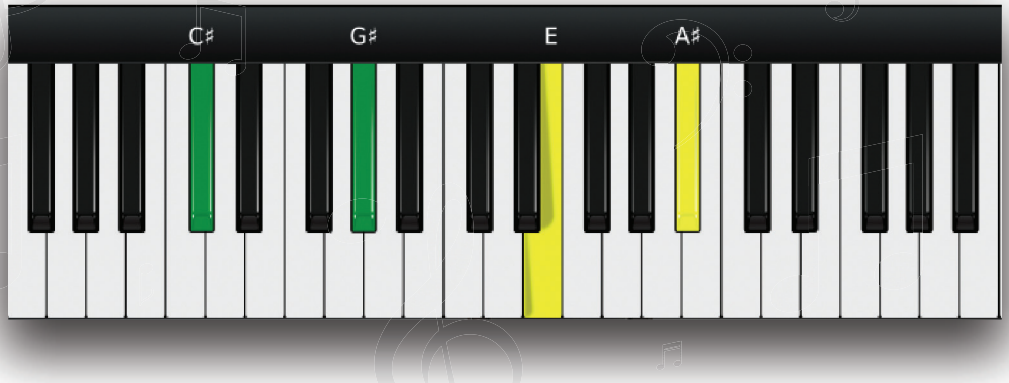


5. Is there a 5th note that functions as the 6th or 9th (b9 or #9) **YES**



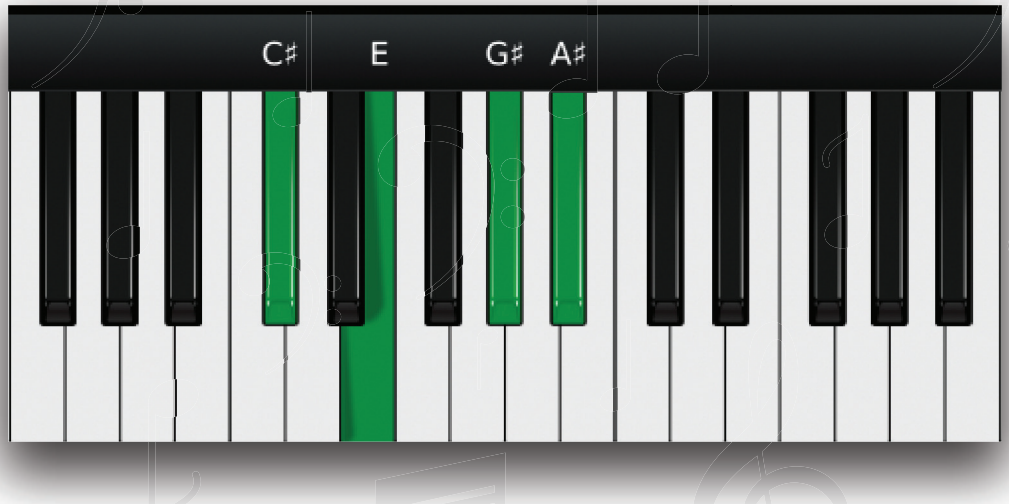
The Chord is: **Gm9**

#14. What is the chord shown below?

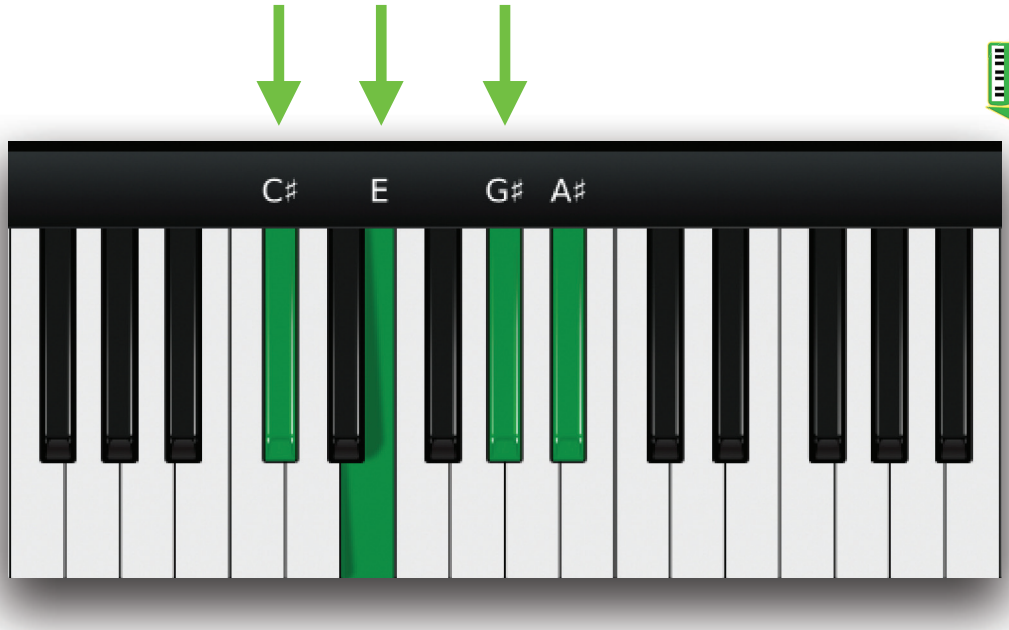


1. Arrange notes in alphabetically order.

1b. Arrange notes in stacked thirds (every other note).

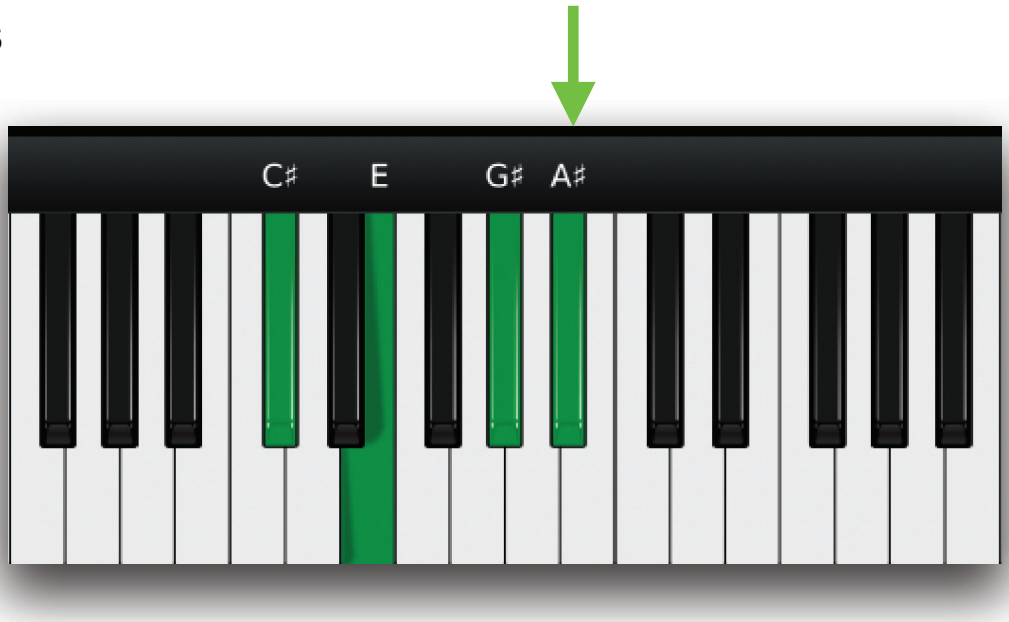


2. Find the three notes that forms the core triad.
3. Determine the quality of the triad (Major, Minor Diminished, Augmented, Sus4). **Minor**



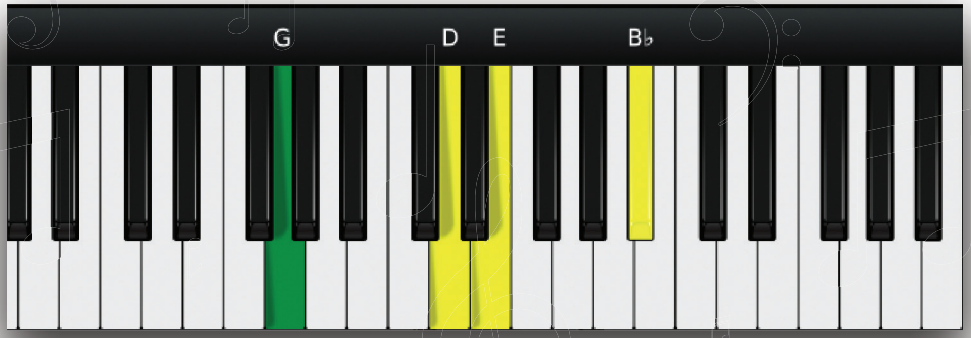
4. Is there a 4th note that functions as the 6th, or 7th (major or minor)?

YES



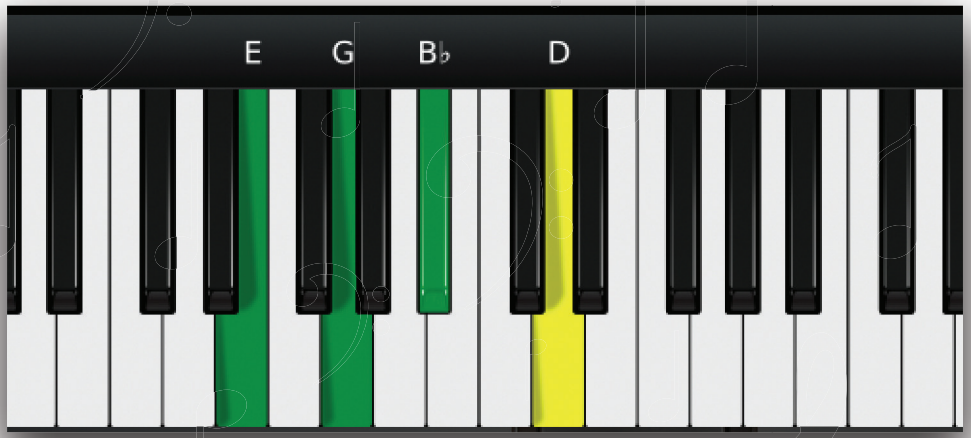
The Chord is: **C#m6**

#15. What is the chord shown below?

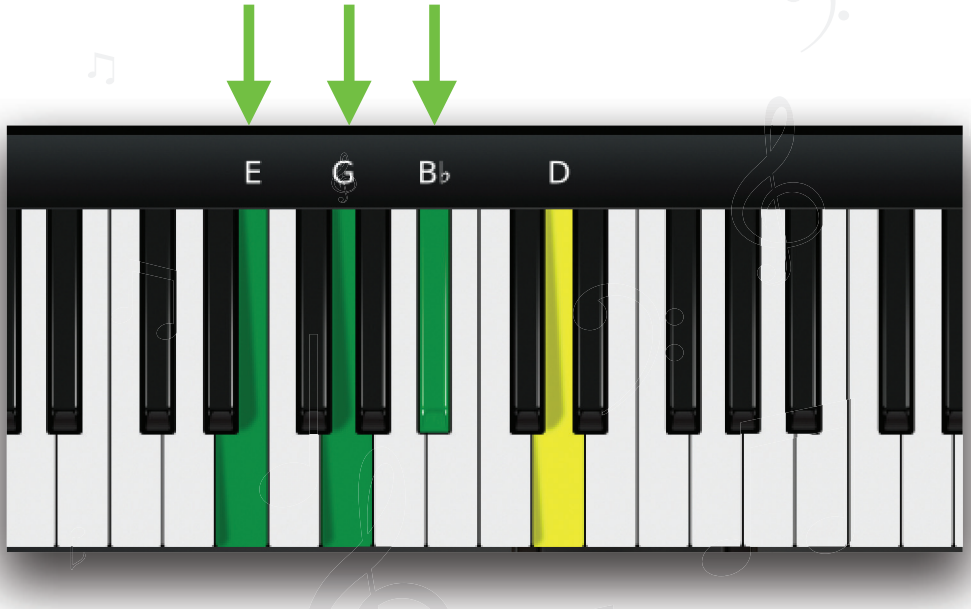


1. Arrange notes in alphabetically order.

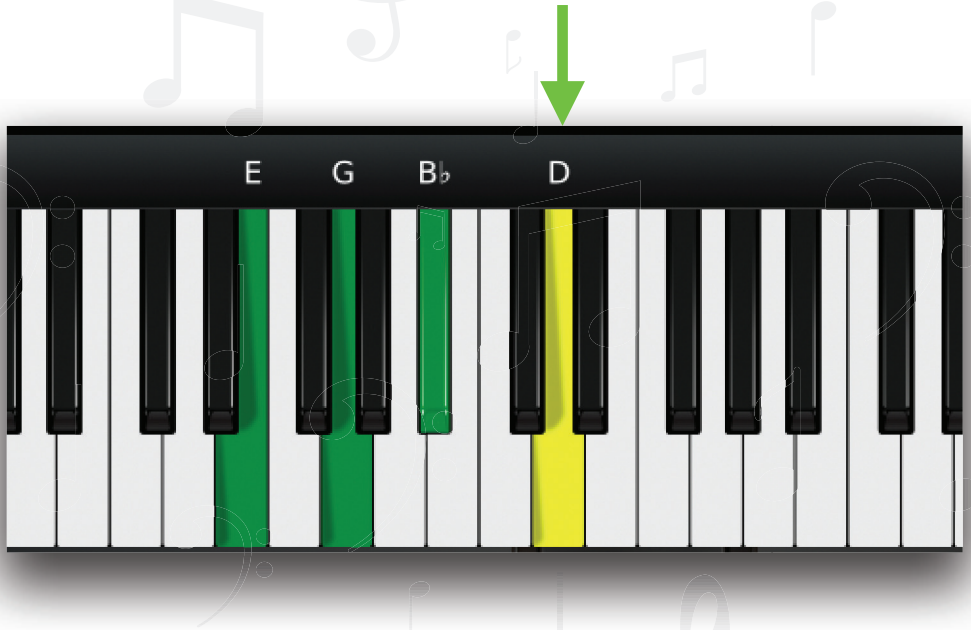
1b. Arrange notes in stacked thirds (every other note).



2. Find the three notes that forms the core triad.
3. Determine the quality of the triad (Major, Minor Diminished, Augmented, Sus4). **Diminished**

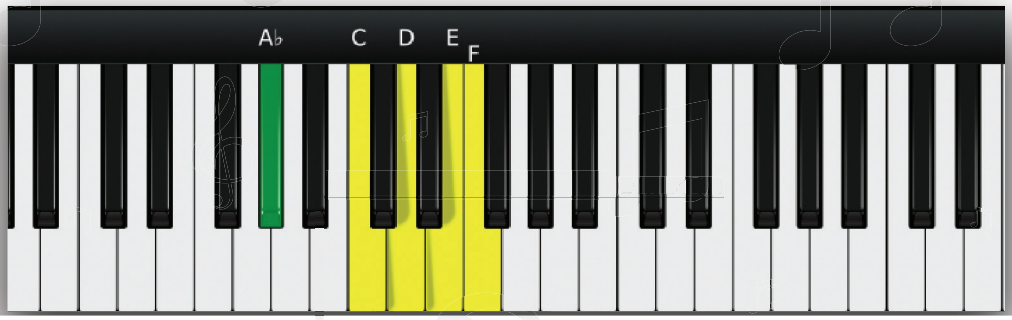


4. Is there a 4th note that functions as the 6th, or 7th (major or minor)?



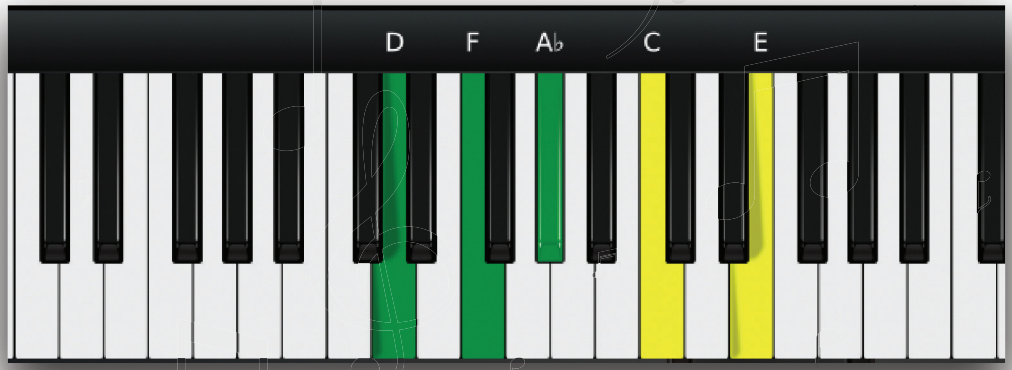
The Chord is: **Em7(b5)**

#16. What is the chord shown below?



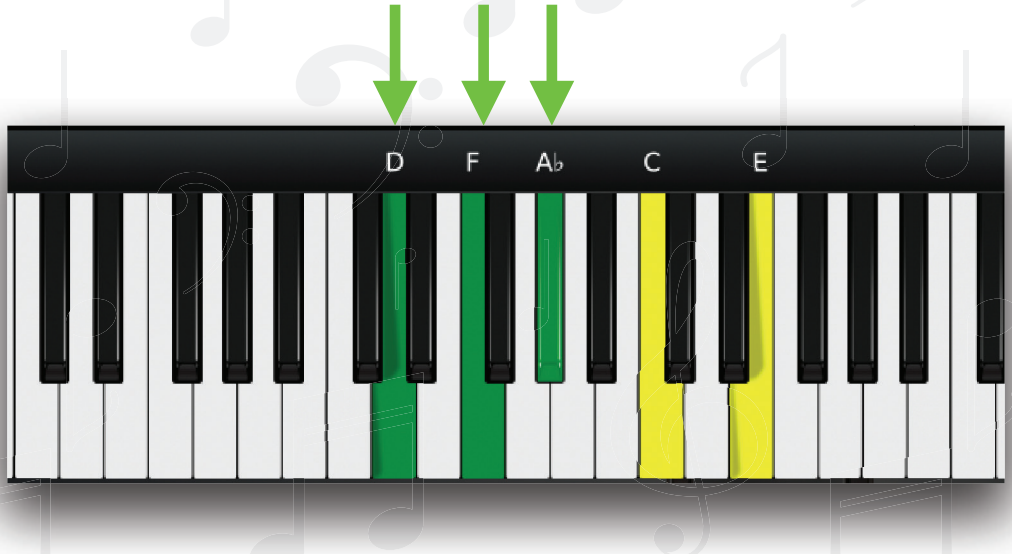
1. Arrange notes in alphabetically order.

1b. Arrange notes in stacked thirds (every other note).

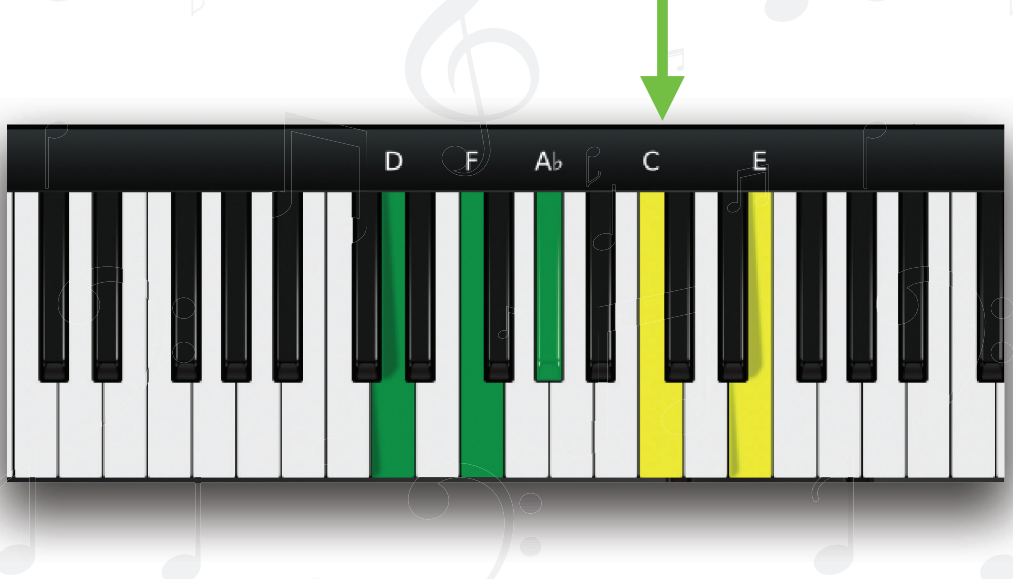


2. Find the three notes that forms the core triad.

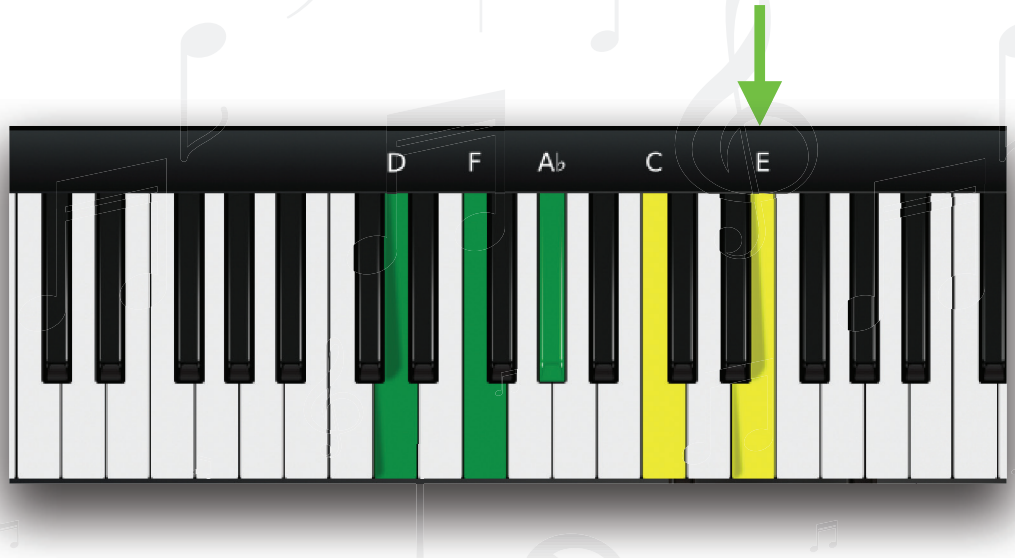
3. Determine the quality of the triad (Major, Minor Diminished, Augmented, Sus4). **Diminished**



4. there a 4th note that functions as the 6th, or 7th (major or minor)?



5. Is there a 5th note that functions as the 6th or 9th (b9 or #9) **YES**



The Chord is: **Dm9(b5)**

